

EDF to encourage electronics, IT manufacturing

J.S. Deepak, secretary, Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY), while addressing the gathering at a symposium jointly organised by Canbank Venture Capital Fund and Venture Intelligence, has said that setting up of the electronics development fund (EDF) marks the fulfilment of a long-felt need.

He said that EDF will offer risk capital to industry and academia to encourage entrepreneurs to manufacture electronics locally and to reduce imports in the next five years.

He also encouraged concentrating more on designing in the electronics and IT industry in India, citing the loss of about US\$ 15 billion due to intellectual property rights.

Chhattisgarh signs MoUs for electronics manufacturing

Chhattisgarh government has signed 11 memoranda of understanding (MoUs) worth ₹ 9.68 billion with 11 investors for manufacturing electronic components in the electronics manufacturing cluster (EMC) in Naya Raipur, the new state capital.

The investment intent in the electronics sector will boost IT and electronics sectors in the state and will approve state's commitment and efforts to develop the sector. Naya Raipur, the first green field capital smartcity of the country will witness the development of electronics sector in the state owing to its state-of-the-art infrastructure. This will also provide opportunity for skilled youths and professionals in the state and entrepreneurs in IT and electronics sector.

Odisha plans electronics, IT hub

With the aim to invite more investments in IT and electronics sectors, Odisha government is developing a dedicated hub at Naraj, near

In Focus

Sandeep Girotra to head Nokia-Alcatel India

Nokia has named Sandeep Girotra head of India as part of the planned combination of Nokia and Alcatel-Lucent, after and subject to the successful closing of the public exchange offer for Alcatel-Lucent securities.

BlackBerry appoints Narendra Nayak as India MD

Narendra Nayak has been named MD for BlackBerry's India operations. He has more than 30 years of experience in IT and telecom business management.

Two new GMs take charge at BEL

Two new GMs have assumed charge

at Navratna Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL). They are A. Ravisankaran, GM, Central D&E/BEL, Bengaluru, and Manoj Kumar, GM, BEL-Kodtwara.

R. Sreedharan appointed MD of Unisys India

Ravikumar Sreedharan has been appointed as MD of IT solutions company Unisys Corp. for its India unit, with effect from October 31.

Ayan Mukerji quits Wipro

Ayan Mukerji, who was heading the media and telecom business unit, has resigned from Wipro to pursue other opportunities.

Cuttack. To get investors, the state government has unveiled exclusive incentives for electronics system design and manufacturing investors. Investors with an investment exceeding ₹ 2 billion and offering employment potential of over 500 would be entitled to 25 per cent investment subsidy on capital investment subject to a ceiling of ₹ 500 million. Also, if their project is financed by public sector banks, the state government would offer an interest subvention of five per cent.

The state government is also developing a green-field EMC located at Harapur, Gaudakasipur and Durgapur villages of Khurda district. It is expected to house over 100 electronics manufacturing units with an employment potential of 10,000-12,000, which will be a mix of skilled and semi-skilled personnel.

Government's DeitY has awarded in-principle approval for the EMC project and approved a grant of ₹ 969.6 million for the same.

Electronics hardware would need 8.9 million workers soon

According to a report by National Skill Development Corp. (NSDC), around 8.9 million skilled workers

will be required in the electronics and IT hardware sector by 2022. As per the report, electronics and IT hardware are the emerging sectors for job creation in India and employ over 4.3 million people across the country.

According to the report, India's per capita GDP has nearly tripled since 2000, rising from US\$ 455 to US\$ 1489 in 2012. This is further expected to rise to over US\$ 2000 by 2017, and will continue to be the major source of demand in consumer electronics in the country.

Key government-initiated programmes like UIDAI project, National Knowledge Network and National Optic Fiber Network will continue to be the primary demand drivers for this sector.

India to replace all streetlights with LEDs

LED manufacturers in the country have a lot to be happy about. India is expected to replace all its streetlights with LEDs in the next two years, a move that will save electricity.

Presently, India has 35 million streetlights and the electricity required to run these is a mammoth 3.4GW a year. With the switch to LEDs, this